

# Ohio River Trail Council Cycling Club

## Ghost Town Trail

26 or 38-Mile Bike Trail Ride

**City / State:** Blacklick, Pennsylvania

**Counties:** Indiana, Cambria

**Date:** Sunday, June 17, 2012

**Time:** 10:00 am

**Meeting Point:** [Saylor Park Trailhead](#) (Google Map)

**Surface:** Crushed Limestone, Asphalt.

**RSVP:** [ortctrailride@ohiorivertrail.org](mailto:ortctrailride@ohiorivertrail.org)



Come out for a ride! This is part of a trail ride series sponsored by the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) intended to bring awareness to the wonderful trails in our 4-state region (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia).

***All riders are welcome for this rails-to-trails, moderate-paced ride!***

***For this ride...***

Join the ORTC Cycling Club as we visit the *Ghost Town Trail* for a 26 or 38-mile round-trip ride from Blacklick to Dilltown or Blacklick to Vintondale, Pa. The Ghost Town Trail extends 36 miles through Indiana and Cambria Counties, Pennsylvania. The trail was originally established in 1991 when the Kovalchick Salvage Company donated 16 miles of the former Ebensburg & Black Lick Railroad to Indiana County. In 1993 the Cambria & Indiana Railroad donated an additional 4 miles from Rexis to White Mill Station known as the Rexis Branch. In 2005 an additional 20 miles were added to the trail - 12 miles in Indiana County and 8 miles in Cambria County. The *Ghost Town Trail* is designated by the U.S. Department of the Interior National Park Service as a National Recreation Trail.

[RTC Trail of the Month: June 2011](#)

[Ghost Town Trail - Blacklick to Dilltown Map](#)

[Ghost Town Trail - Dilltown to Nanty Glo Map](#)

[Ghost Town Trail - Nanty Glo to Ebensburg Map](#)

[Ghost Town Trail - Mileage Chart](#)

### **Features of Interest:**

The Ghost Town Trail derives its name from numerous mining towns that once existed

along the railroad corridor. Wehrum, the largest of the former towns, once had 230 houses, a hotel, company store, jail, and bank. Warren Delano, uncle of President Franklin Roosevelt, developed the town. Other ghost towns include Bracken, Armerford, Lackawanna #3, Scott Glenn, Webster, Beulah, and Claghorn.

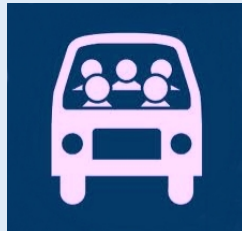
The Eliza Furnace, in Vintondale, is one of Pennsylvania's best preserved iron furnaces. An interpretive exhibit is located at the site. The furnace is on the National Register of Historic Places. Historical markers along the trail provide interpretive information about the Black Lick Valley's intriguing history. Dating from 1846 the Eliza Furnace is one of only a few iron furnaces remaining in the United States which still retains its original heat exchanger piping. The two-acre site is leased to Indiana County by the Cambria County Historical Society.

The furnace operated from 1846 to 1849 and is a unique relic of the Black Lick Valley's early industrial era. At its peak, the furnace employed over 90 people and utilized 45 mules to produce about 1,080 tons of iron a year. The furnace was not a financial success, and operated only three years. Difficulties in transporting iron by teams of horses to Ninevah on the Pennsylvania Canal, poor-quality local ore, and a significant drop in iron prices sealed the furnace's fate. Despite its early closing, Eliza Furnace helped bring the industrial revolution to the Black Lick Valley.

*Don't forget your camera!*

#### **Carpooling:**

We are glad to facilitate carpooling as well. Just RSVP or contact the ORTC at [ortctrailride@ohiorivertrail.org](mailto:ortctrailride@ohiorivertrail.org). Carpooling meeting locations are either Beaver, Cranberry Twp., Moon Twp., or Pittsburgh, Pa.



#### **Weather & Cancellations:**

The weather forecast is mostly sunny and 74 degrees. Please visit the [ORTC website](#) for cancellations before you depart for the trail. In addition, persons who RSVP will be sent an email regarding schedule changes. Rides that are cancelled due to inclement weather are usually rescheduled for the next day for Saturday rides or the following week for Sunday rides.

#### **Trailhead Address and Directions:**

Saylor Park  
1284 Old Indiana Road  
Blairsville, PA 15717



Saylor Park is 1 mile from Route 119. At the Sheetz Store in Blacklick, PA follow Old Indiana Road for one mile to Saylor Park.

[Saylor Park Trailhead Map](#)

Saylor Park Trailhead Photo #1

**Drive time**

Pittsburgh: 75 minutes

Moon Twp: 95 minutes

Monaca: 114 minutes

**GPS:** 40.478162,-79.187222

**Website Links:**

<http://www.indianacountyparks.org/trails/gtt/gtt.html>

<http://www.traillink.com/trail/ghost-town-trail.aspx>

**Lunch:**

We will meet for lunch after the ride. The Dillweed Bed & Breakfast and Trailside Shop is located in along the trail in Dilltown for food and refreshments.

***Ohio River Trail Council***

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is a Pennsylvania based non-profit, volunteer-led corporation whose mission is to establish, promote, protect and preserve a multi-use trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the "La Belle Riviere" or the Ohio River and its tributaries.

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is currently planning & developing a 41-mile bike and water trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the Ohio River, from Coraopolis, Pa (near Pittsburgh) to Ohioville, Pa. (near East Liverpool, OH). The ORT is part of the *Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area*, *Lewis & Clark Trail* and is a candidate for part of the *U.S. Bicycle Route 50, Pittsburgh to Cleveland Trail*, and a portion of the *Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh spur*. The proposed ORT will also follow parts of the "*Great Path*" and the *Lincoln Highway*. The ORT will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia). Specifically, the proposed Ohio River Trail will connect the *Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway* in Columbiana County, Ohio to the *Great Allegheny Passage* in Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol.



## Donations

The ORTC is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to form an alliance with us to capitalize on our strengths in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns. Please visit [www.ohiorivertrail.org](http://www.ohiorivertrail.org) for additional information and a [donation form](#).



## Ohio River Trail Cycling Club

The Ohio River Trail Cycling Club is a recreational club that promotes health, wellness and fitness in our community through a variety of biking events. Our goal is to encourage cyclists of all abilities to explore the wonderful opportunities of the region - from the Heritage Trail of Pittsburgh to the rural scenery of the 4-state area, including Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The club provides cyclists with a diversity of riding experiences. Ohio River Trail Council members can be seen on city bikes, comfort bikes, cyclocross bikes, hybrids, mountain bikes, recumbents, road bikes, touring bikes and tandems.

The ORTC Cycling Club supports and promotes safe bicycle riding. If you have been inactive for several years or are currently under medical care, please consult your doctor before starting a new exercise program. It is highly recommended to always carry water and food. In addition, please bring a spare tube, pump and tools to replace a flat tire. A Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) approved bicycle helmet securely fitted and fastened is required on all ORTC Trail Series Rides. In order to participate in our events please print and sign the [OHIO RIVER TRAIL COUNCIL CYCLING CLUB RELEASE](#) and mail to ORTC 1100 Pennsylvania Av Monaca, Pa 15061. The ORTC club members serve as ambassadors for bicycling every time we ride thus projecting a positive image of bicycling to the public. Always follow the rules of the road!

About the Trail Ride Series:

- Trails rides are 10-50 miles in length.
- Moderate and self-paced rides located within a 2 hour drive of Pittsburgh, Pa.
- Meet for lunch or dinner either mid-way or at the end.
- Two - four rides per month on Saturday or Sunday.
- Feel free to forward this email. This publication is intended for widespread distribution.

Example rides include the [Allegheny Highlands Trail](#), [Allegheny River & Samuel Justus Trails](#), [Armstrong Trail](#), [Arrowhead Trail](#), [Bike and Hike Trail](#), [Butler-Freeport Trail](#), [C & O Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Conotton Creek Trail](#), [Deckers Creek Trail](#), [Ghost Town Trail](#), [Greater Wheeling Trail](#), [Hoodlebug Trail](#), [Little Beaver Creek Greenway](#), [Lower Trail](#), [Mahoning Shadow Trail](#), [Maurice K. Goddard State Park Trail](#), [Mill Creek MetroParks Bikeway](#), [Montour Trail](#), [Ohio & Erie Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Oil Creek State Park Trail](#), [Panhandle Trail](#), [Pine](#)

[Creek Trail](#), [Sandy Creek Trail](#), [Stavich Trail](#), [Steel Valley Trail](#), [Three Rivers Heritage Trail](#), [Western Reserve Greenway Trumbull MetroParks](#), [West Penn Trail](#), and [Youghiogheny River Trail](#).

### **Ride Schedule**

Please refer to the provisional ORTC Trail Series [Ride Schedule](#) or ORTC [Event Calendar](#) for additional dates and times. Click here to view the [ORTC meeting schedule](#).

### **Membership**

To join the Ohio River Trail Council and become a member of the ORTC Cycling Club please download a [membership application](#) and mail your contribution to the ORTC office. Feel free to forward this message to a friend.



### **Correspondence**

Please visit our [website](#) and [register](#) to receive ORTC correspondence. Thank you for your support.



***For questions and comments please contact:***

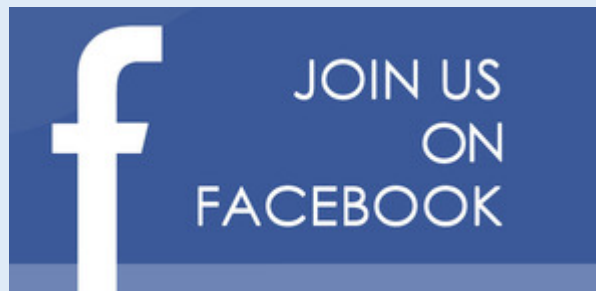
Dr. Vincent Troia  
Chief Executive Chairman & CEO  
Ohio River Trail Council  
1100 Pennsylvania Av  
Monaca, Pa 15061  
724.728.2625



Nathan Peluso  
Vice President  
Chairman Trail Towns & ORTC Clubs  
Ohio River Trail Council  
1100 Pennsylvania Av  
Monaca, Pa 15061



This email is intended for widespread distribution, feel free to forward.  
[Forward this message to a friend](#)



Become a friend of the [Ohio River Trail](#) on [Facebook](#)  
Become a fan of the [Ohio River Trail Council](#) on [Facebook](#).  
Support the [Ohio River Trail Cause](#) on [Facebook](#).  
Receive our tweets on [Twitter](#): ORTC\_Monaca



Follow us on  
**Twitter**



[Ohio River Trail Council Cycling Club](#)

**Copyright © 2012 ORTC**



---

[Click to view this email in a browser](#)

If you no longer wish to receive these emails, please reply to this message with "Unsubscribe" in the subject line or simply click on the following link: [Unsubscribe](#)

---

Ohio River Trail Council  
1100 Pennsylvania AV  
Monaca, Pennsylvania 15061  
US

[Read](#) the VerticalResponse marketing policy.

